



RELOCATION GUIDE

Northland

Te Tai Tokerau

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Northland.

Two coasts, one long peninsula. Generalist work that is genuinely needed.

Nau mai, haere mai ki Te Tai Tokerau. Northland is where New Zealand's story starts, and the warmest, greenest, most coastline-rich region in the country. It is rural and relaxed, with room to breathe, and it suits clinicians who love space, water and broad, generalist work. This guide shows you what life here is really like.

~200k

people across the whole region

~55k

in Whāngārei, the region's city

~35%

identify as Māori, the highest of any region

2 hrs 15

Whāngārei to central Auckland by road

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why people choose Northland

Northland rewards people who love the outdoors and enjoy generalist work. Here is what makes it special, and what to plan for.

Clinical pay in New Zealand is set nationally. A nurse, physiotherapist or radiographer on a given step earns the same in Whāngārei as in Auckland. What changes is what the money buys and what the day feels like.

Northland housing is among the most affordable in the country. A family home with a garden, fifteen minutes from the hospital and twenty from a beach, is an ordinary purchase here on a single clinical salary, and that changes what the money buys.

The climate is genuinely subtropical. People call it the winterless north, and it is not marketing. Frost is unusual near the coast and nowhere is more than about forty kilometres from the sea.



Monday to Friday

10-20 MIN COMMUTE

Free, easy parking in Whāngārei. Longer at a rural site, on open roads with a view.



After work

OCT - MAY

A swim, a walk up Mount Manaia, or the harbour at Town Basin. The water is warm enough for most of the year.



Saturday

ON THE WATER

An east-coast beach, the farmers' market, or the boat. Boat ownership is far more common here than anywhere else in New Zealand.



Sunday

KAURI OR THE GARDEN

Waipoua Forest, the Hokianga, or a garden that grows all year.



The kind of beach you can often have to yourself.

It suits you best if...

- ✓ You'd rather have a beach to yourself than a busy restaurant strip. If big-city nightlife is high on your list, Northland isn't that; Whāngārei and Kerikeri cover the everyday, and Auckland is there for big nights out.
- ✓ You enjoy the drive. Outside Whāngārei, a car is how everyone gets around, and the roads come with views.
- ✓ You want work with real purpose. Health equity is the daily work here, and it is deeply meaningful.
- ✓ You enjoy broad, generalist work, with Auckland's subspecialty teams a referral away.
- ✓ You're happy to fly home via Auckland Airport, roughly three hours from Whāngārei, or by a short flight from Whāngārei or Kerikeri.

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If you're comparing regions

Warmth and coast with a bigger city: the Bay of Plenty or Hawke's Bay. Great value with a larger hospital and city: Waikato or Palmerston North. The widest range of roles and the biggest international community: Auckland.

How the region is laid out

Three hundred kilometres from Auckland's northern edge to Cape Rēinga, and rarely more than eighty wide. State Highway 1 runs the length of it, and almost everything sits along that spine.

The east coast faces the Pacific: sheltered, island-scattered, warm and calm, with the Bay of Islands at its centre. This is the postcard Northland and where most people live. The west faces the Tasman: dramatic black-sand beaches, with the Hokianga harbour and the great kauri forests behind it. Peaceful, uncrowded, and a wilder kind of beauty.

THE REGION'S CITY

Whāngārei & the Heads

Around 55,000 people on a harbour, with a rebuilt waterfront at Town Basin and the base hospital. Twenty minutes east, the beaches under Mount Manaia.

AN HOUR NORTH

The Bay of Islands

Kerikeri, Paihia, Russell and Waitangi. Subtropical, the founding place of the nation and the region's tourism heart.

TWO AND A HALF HOURS

The Far North

Kaitaia, Doubtless Bay, Ninety Mile Beach and Cape Rēinga. Wild and beautiful, and a place where rural health services make a real difference.

THE WEST

Kauri Coast & Kaipara

Dargaville, the Hokianga and Waipoua Forest. Farming and forestry country, and the most peaceful part of Northland.



Mount Manaia at Whāngārei Heads: a steep, short climb twenty-five minutes from the city.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Around 24–26°, hot and humid, with the sea at its warmest. The region fills with holidaymakers over Christmas.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 20–23°. Arguably the best of the year: swimmable into April, crowds gone, beautiful light.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Around 15–16°, mild and green. Frost is rare near the coast; the thing to manage is damp, not cold.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 18–21°, warming fast with some breezy days. The sea is swimmable again by late October.

The Bay of Islands is where Māori and Europeans first sustained contact, and where Te Tiriti o Waitangi was signed in 1840. Around a third of Northlanders identify as Māori, and iwi and hapū are significant partners in health services. You will meet te ao Māori in clinical practice here more directly than anywhere else in the country. Arrive ready to learn.

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A note on te reo

Whāngārei, Kerikeri, Kaitaia, Kaikohe: the map here is overwhelmingly Māori, and pronouncing it properly is especially valued in this region. Nobody expects you to arrive fluent, and people warmly appreciate it when you try.

Healthcare and work in Northland

For a clinician who wants breadth and autonomy, Northland is one of the most interesting places in the country to work. If a narrow subspecialty is your goal, a larger centre may suit better; if you love variety, this is the place.

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora runs public healthcare nationally. In Northland that means a base hospital in Whāngārei, a network of rural hospitals and community services down the peninsula, and a strong presence of Māori health providers delivering care in partnership. Complex tertiary work goes to Auckland, two and a quarter hours south.

WHĀNGĀREI

The base hospital

The region's acute centre: emergency, inpatient medicine and surgery, maternity, intensive care and the hub for outpatient services.

FAR NORTH, BAY OF ISLANDS, KAURI COAST, HOKIANGA

Rural hospitals

Genuine rural generalist practice. Some roles sit at one site; many rotate, with retrieval and transfer a familiar part of the work.

ACROSS THE REGION

Māori health providers

Iwi and hapū-led services deliver a significant share of primary and community care, particularly in the Far North and Hokianga.

CLOSE TO HOME

Primary & community care

General practice, community nursing and outreach clinics play a bigger role here than in a city, bringing care close to people's homes.

WHAT NORTHLAND GIVES YOU

Your scope widens

With subspecialists further away, you handle more yourself and build real confidence. Many call it their most interesting work.

Equity is the daily work

It is part of every shift, not a policy or a module. If closing that gap is why you came into healthcare, the work is real.

Te ao Māori is embedded

Karakia, whanaungatanga, and working with whānau rather than the individual in front of you.

Your patients are your neighbours

In a region this size you will see people you know. Most find that grounding.

GOOD TO KNOW

Broad rather than narrow

Highly specialised work is referred to Auckland, so the roles here are ideal for people who enjoy breadth.

Meaningful, complex work

Patients often present later and with more social complexity than in a city, which is exactly where good care makes a difference.

Belonging, not just working

Engaging warmly with te ao Māori is what turns working here into belonging here.

Teamwork across distance

Road and air retrieval south is part of the job, and teams plan around the weather together.



Northland suits clinicians who want generalist breadth and a beach they don't share. The work is genuinely needed, which is its own kind of job satisfaction.

Everyday care for your own family

- ☐ Enrol with a GP in your first fortnight. Demand is high and some practices have closed books, so starting early pays off.
- ☐ Know your nearest urgent care before you need it, especially if you live rurally.
- ☐ Save 111 and Healthline (0800 611 116), which is genuinely useful when you're rural and unsure.
- ☐ For some specialist appointments, families make a day trip to Auckland, and many pair it with a shop or a visit.

Where to live in Northland

A Whāngārei suburb, a coastal village, a Bay of Islands town or the Far North are four genuinely different lives, each with its own appeal, and the drive between them is measured in hours.

Ask three questions. City, coast or country? Which house will stay warm and dry? And how far do you want to drive? An hour each way to Kerikeri is lovely in February and a longer run on a wet July night, so if you are on call, living closer makes life easy.

Choose a dry house first and a pretty one second. Older weatherboard houses near the coast can hold damp, so look for mould at window frames and in wardrobes, and ask what extraction the kitchen and bathroom have. Newer homes are usually warmer and drier.

WHĀNGĀREI · ~5 MIN TO THE BASE HOSPITAL

Kensington

Closest to the hospital and where many clinical staff live. Established housing and mature trees; check older homes for damp.

WHĀNGĀREI · ~7 MIN

Maunu

Larger sections, newer and drier houses, and a well-regarded primary. Calm and residential.

WHĀNGĀREI NORTH · ~12 MIN

Kamo

Its own shops, schools and pool, with plenty of post-1990s housing, which here means drier and warmer.

HARBOURSIDE · ~12 MIN

Onerahi

Water views from the higher streets and good value for proximity to the harbour and hospital.

~25–40 MIN

Parua Bay & the Heads

Water at the end of the street and Mount Manaia behind, with a scenic, winding commute and a lively summer.

SOUTH · ~35 MIN

Ruakaka & Waipu

Long surf beaches, a lot of new building, and the shortest run to Auckland in the region.

BAY OF ISLANDS

Kerikeri

A lovely, liveable town: a real high street, good schools and an airport. An ideal home if you work in the Bay of Islands.

FAR NORTH & KAURI COAST

Kaitaia & Dargaville

The most affordable housing and some of the most rewarding rural work in the country, best suited to people working at those sites.



Central Whāngārei, the region's city centre.

IF YOU REMEMBER THREE THINGS

- ✓ City, coast, Bay of Islands or Far North are four different lives. Decide which one you want first.
- ✓ Rent for six months before you buy. It shows you which part of the region suits your family best.
- ✓ Good listings move fast, so start looking early and be ready to view quickly.

Getting around Northland

A reliable car is how everyone gets around here, and most households run two. The drives themselves are part of the pleasure.

SH1 runs the length of the peninsula. South to Auckland it has been progressively improved; north of Whāngārei it is a two-lane rural highway. Northland roads follow hills and harbour edges, so a journey that looks like forty minutes on a map is often an hour, with views the whole way. Locals quote everything in driving time, and within a month you will too.



Most of the region's roads look like this: two lanes, curves, and a view.



Whāngārei Heads

~25 MIN

The beaches under Mount Manaia, the everyday escape.



Dargaville

~1 HOUR

West to the Kauri Coast and the Tasman side.



Kerikeri

~1 HR 15

The main north-south hop within the region.



Auckland city

~2 HR 15

On a good run. Allow an hour more for the airport, and extra on a Friday.



Kaitia

~2 HR 30

The gateway to the Far North.



Cape Rēinga

~4 HOURS

Worth every minute, and a trip everyone should make.

Driving tips



Roads wind, with few passing lanes, so leave generous time for connections.



Gravel is normal for beaches and rural addresses, so a car with some clearance is a good choice.



Heavy subtropical rain can bring slips; check road updates before a long trip.



Logging trucks and stock share the roads. Relaxed driving is the local culture.



From Boxing Day to late January, holiday traffic can turn a two-hour run into three and a half.

Whāngārei has a local bus network, and intercity coaches run the SH1 corridor. Whāngārei and Kerikeri both have airports with short flights to Auckland, often worth the fare for an international connection. On the east coast, boats are transport too: the Paihia–Russell ferry, and a car ferry across the Hokianga at Rawene.

What it costs to live here

Your salary in Whāngārei is the same as in Auckland, and Northland housing costs a fraction as much. That gap is the financial case, with fuel and travel to plan for. We don't print prices because they go stale; the relationships don't.

Three things are worth planning for. You will drive more, and rural fuel is generally dearer than in the cities. Some goods cost a little more or take longer to arrive. And specialist care for your family may mean a day trip south. Net of all that, most clinicians are meaningfully better off here than in Auckland.

Typical three-bedroom rent, by place



relative to the dearest place in our list (= 100); proportions, not amounts

Same

clinical pay as Auckland
national collective
agreements

~2.3×

a family's month versus a
single clinician's
childcare alone is roughly
half the family month

2–3×

fuel spend versus a
central-city household

THE MAIN ONE

Fuel

Longer distances and often two cars, so build fuel into the monthly plan.

WINTER POWER

Dehumidifying, not heating

Lower bills than the South Island; a dehumidifier through winter is the one to budget for, and worth it.

SEVERAL A YEAR

The Auckland trip

Specialists, the airport, a big shop: plan for fuel, a full day and sometimes a night away, which many families enjoy as a mini-break.

RURAL ADDRESSES

Delivery and freight

Surcharges are common, so check delivery to rural addresses before you order.



Native bush is never far away, and walking in it costs nothing.

Get today's numbers

- ☐ Tenancy Services market rent: official bond data by area, the most reliable rent figure in New Zealand.
- ☐ Numbeo or Expatistan: compare Northland with the city you are leaving.
- ☐ Stats NZ: updated less often, and the one to trust on the direction of travel.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Northland

Northland is the region I'm most careful to match, because the right person absolutely loves it. It suits clinicians who want to be genuinely capable generalists, who find meaning in work about equity, and who would rather have a beach to themselves than a restaurant open at ten.

The people who thrive here treat the driving as part of the life. They rent first, choose a drier house over a prettier one, and take te ao Māori seriously from the first week. If that sounds like you, the arithmetic of national pay on Northland housing is hard to beat anywhere in the country.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Weekends here so often end up on the beach.

Food and everyday life

Northland eats wonderfully well, built on some of the best growing country in New Zealand.



Paihia's waterfront, at its best in summer.

THE CITY'S BEST EATING

Town Basin, Whāngārei

Restaurants and cafés on the marina, the Hundertwasser Art Centre, and a Saturday growers' market nearby.

A GENUINE FOOD TOWN

Kerikeri

Orchards on the doorstep, good restaurants, a strong Sunday market and wineries a short drive away.

ON THE WATER

Paihia & Russell

Waterfront dining with a holiday feel, at its liveliest in summer.

THE REAL STRENGTH

Markets & roadside stalls

Avocados, feijoas, citrus, kumāra, fish and eggs, often from an honesty box. Keep coins in the car.



An ordinary evening out in Whāngārei, with every table taken.

Outside Whāngārei and Kerikeri, many restaurants keep relaxed hours or take Mondays and Tuesdays off, so it's worth checking before you drive. For specialty groceries, people order online from Auckland suppliers, swap tips with the region's international health workforce, and pack a chilly bin in the boot on every city trip.

Most households do one big fortnightly shop at Pak'nSave in Whāngārei or Kerikeri, top up at the local Four Square, and buy produce and fish from markets and stalls. It works out well.

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Furnishing an empty house

Whāngārei has the big-box retailers for whiteware and flat-pack. Beyond that, Trade Me and Facebook Marketplace are how Northland buys furniture, and the market is lively because people move in and out often. Check delivery before you order anything large to a rural address.



Fresh produce from a market stall: much of it grown just down the road.



Green-lipped mussels, a New Zealand staple on seafood menus.

Weekends, beaches and the outdoors

Two coasts, two hundred beaches, the oldest forest in the country and the founding place of the nation, all within an easy drive of wherever you live.



Whāngārei Falls, fifteen minutes from the city: an after-work walk, not an expedition.



Whāngārei Falls & the kauri parks

15 MIN

A 26-metre waterfall and a canopy walkway through mature kauri.



Ruakaka & Waipu Cove

40 MIN

Long, patrolled surf beaches, and glow-worm caves you can visit for free.



Tutukaka & the Poor Knights

~30 MIN, THEN A BOAT

Diving at the Poor Knights is what people travel for.



The Bay of Islands

1 HR 15

Paihia, Russell, Waitangi and 144 islands: sailing, dolphins and the Treaty Grounds.



Waipoua Forest

~1 HR 45

Tāne Mahuta, the largest living kauri, a short walk from the road.



The Hokianga

2 HRS

Giant dunes, the Rawene ferry and a quiet, deeply Māori part of the country.

Boat ownership here is ordinary rather than aspirational. A trailer boat is within reach on a clinical salary, ramps are everywhere and the east coast is forgiving water. Snapper off the Heads is a normal Saturday. If you have never been a water person, Northland is where you become one.

A typical Northland weekend



Saturday morning at the growers' market in Whāngārei, or the Sunday market in Kerikeri.



Fishing off the rocks, from a kayak or a trailer boat. Snapper is the prize.



Summer camping at a beachfront campground, and long lunches at a vineyard or café in the Bay of Islands.



Junior sport, then the beach. Surf lifesaving clubs run nippers programmes for children over summer.



A short walk with a big view: Mount Manaia, the Hātea Loop around Town Basin, or a kauri park.



Waitangi Day, Matariki and local A&P shows, where much of the region turns out.



Kererū in the bush reserves, ordinary here in a way they aren't elsewhere. Photographed by a Northland anaesthetic technician.



Dark, clear skies: the stars are one of the first things people mention.



The Waipu Caves glow worms, forty minutes south of Whāngārei.

Enjoying the outdoors safely

- ☐ West-coast beaches have strong rips and many are unpatrolled. Swim between the flags.
- ☐ Clean your footwear at every kauri dieback station.
- ☐ The UV is among the highest in the country, overcast days included.
- ☐ After heavy rain, check road updates before heading west or into the Far North.

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If you have never been a water person, Northland is where you become one. If you already are, you'll feel right at home.

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Worth planning for

Big concerts, theatre and international sport are a trip to Auckland, which makes a good weekend away in itself. The region moves with the seasons: January is lively and booked out, while June is mild, calm and beautifully uncrowded.



Mount Manaia at Whangārei Heads: the summit track is a favourite Saturday climb.

Day trips and weekends away

From Whāngārei, the Bay of Islands, the Tutukaka coast and the great kauri forests are all easy day trips, and Auckland is close enough for a city weekend.

Head north for the Bay of Islands: Kerikeri's orchards and Stone Store, Paihia, Russell and the Treaty Grounds at Waitangi. Go west for Waipoua Forest and the Hokianga's giant dunes, or all the way up Ninety Mile Beach to Cape Rēinga, where the Tasman meets the Pacific.

South, the road to Auckland passes Waipu, Mangawhai and Matakana. Auckland itself, a little over two hours away, adds the museums, concerts, international sport and the airport for trips home.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Whāngārei Heads beaches (e.g. Ocean Beach)	~30 min	The nearest swimming and surf beaches, under Mount Manaia
Ruakākā & Waipu Cove	~35–40 min	Long, patrolled surf beaches
Ski fields (Whakapapa & Tūroa, Mt Ruapehu)	~6.5–7 hrs	Snow for a winter trip, best as a long weekend
Auckland (nearest major city)	~2 hrs 15	Museums, concerts, shopping and international sport
Auckland Airport	~2.5–3 hrs	The international airport; Whāngārei and Kerikeri have short flights to Auckland
Tutukaka & the Poor Knights	~30 min, then a boat	World-class diving and snorkelling
Bay of Islands	~1 hr 15	Sailing, dolphins and the Waitangi Treaty Grounds
Waipoua Forest	~1 hr 45	Tāne Mahuta, the largest living kauri
Cape Rēinga	~4 hrs	The lighthouse at the top of the country

~1 HR 15

Waitangi Treaty Grounds

Where Te Tiriti o Waitangi was signed in 1840. The museum, the carved meeting house and the waka make it the best history lesson in the country.

~1 HR 15, THEN A SHORT FERRY

Russell by ferry

Cross from Paihia to the old whaling town, walk up Flagstaff Hill and eat fish and chips on the strand.

~1 HR

Kerikeri

The Stone Store and Mission House, Rainbow Falls, orchards, cafés and the Sunday market.

~1 HR 45–2 HRS

Tāne Mahuta & the Hokianga

Stand beneath the largest living kauri, then sandboard the dunes across the harbour from Ōpononi.

~4 HRS

Ninety Mile Beach & Cape Rēinga

The far end of the country: giant dunes at Te Pahi and the lighthouse above two oceans. Best as an overnight trip.

~1–1.5 HRS

Mangawhai & Matakana

A surf beach and cliff walk at Mangawhai, then the village market at Matakana on the way south.

~2 HRS 15

Auckland for the weekend

A concert or a test match, the museum and the harbour ferries, and a big shop on the way home.



A sheltered cove on the Northland coast, the kind of beach you can often have to yourself.



Auckland from its eastern waterfront, a little over two hours south.

Schools and family life

Space, beaches, warmth, safety and a relaxed pace make Northland a wonderful place for children. For teenagers, it's worth exploring subject and sport choices early.

Childhood here is outdoors: beaches, rivers, bush walks and a back garden that grows feijoas. Whāngārei has the Hātea Loop around Town Basin, playgrounds in most suburbs, an indoor aquatic centre and a free public library. Kiwi North at Maunu has a kiwi house that children love.

Children often walk or bike to school in the smaller towns, and weekends revolve around sport, surf club and family. Communities are close, and newcomers with children tend to be welcomed quickly.



Summer holidays here mean a tent, a bay and all the time in the world.

What the schools are like

- ✓ Most children go to state schools. There are also state-integrated schools, often with a church character, and a small number of independent schools.
- ✓ Children usually start at five. Primary is Years 1–6, intermediate Years 7–8 and secondary Years 9–13; in smaller towns, area schools cover every year.
- ✓ Some schools in Whāngārei run enrolment zones. Check the address is in-zone before you sign a lease.
- ✓ Every school's Education Review Office report is free to read at ero.govt.nz.
- ✓ For three- to five-year-olds, 20 Hours ECE funds up to 20 hours a week at participating centres and kindergartens.

Kensington and Maunu suit families wanting established schools close to work; Kerikeri has a good reputation if you work in the Bay of Islands. Whāngārei has the widest secondary choice, including Whāngārei Boys' and Whāngārei Girls' High Schools.

Secondary schools are smaller than city schools, with the close attention that brings, so explore subject and sport options early. Te Kura, the national distance school, can add a specialist subject. NorthTec, the regional polytechnic, is based in Whāngārei; for university, most students head to Auckland.

For children with asthma, a dry home makes a real difference. Ventilation, extractor fans and a dehumidifier are worth more than heating when you choose a house.

~15 min

from most of Whāngārei to
a swimmable beach

Rare

frost near the coast

Oct – May

the swimming season

Worth knowing before you come

- ✓ Northland's health workforce has recruited internationally for decades; you won't be the only overseas family.
- ✓ Trips home start with a drive or a short flight to Auckland, so plan for fuel, parking and an extra day.
- ✓ Diaspora communities are close-knit. It's worth connecting before you arrive, and many friendships grow through the hospital.



A waterfall at the end of a bush walk: an easy family day out.



Your patients are your neighbours and your colleagues are your friends. That is what makes practising here so rewarding.

Your Northland address book

Whangārei is the hub. It has a small but organised Indian and Malayali community, a mosque and a gurdwara, and a newcomer network built around Multicultural Whangārei and WINGS. In Kerikeri and the Bay of Islands there are fewer services, so most people come into Whangārei for community events and specialist groceries.

COUNCILS

Whangārei District Council

Rates, rubbish, libraries, parks and building consents in and around the city

wdc.govt.nz

Far North District Council

Kerikeri, the Bay of Islands, Kaitiāia and everything north

fndc.govt.nz

Kaipara District Council

Dargaville, Mangawhai and the west coast south of Whangārei

kaipara.govt.nz

Northland Regional Council

Regional council: the CityLink and regional bus services, environment and civil defence

nrc.govt.nz

SETTLING IN & EXPLORING

New Zealand Newcomers Network

Local newcomers' groups, including Whangārei

newcomers.co.nz

Northland NZ

The regional tourism site: beaches, walks, events and what's on

northlandnz.com

Department of Conservation

Tracks, huts and campsites across the region's conservation land

doc.govt.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Multicultural Whangārei

Main settlement support for migrants: English classes, cultural groups, employment help and social events

09 430 0571 mwhg.org.nz

WINGS (Women's International Newcomers Group Social)

Free friendship network for women: coffee mornings, book club, dance and fitness sessions

wingsnz.org.nz

Whangarei Malayalam Association (WMA)

Kerala community in Whangārei; helps new arrivals settle; Onam, Christmas and cultural events

wmaofficial.org

Northland Indian Association

Indian cultural association, est. 2008; music, dance, sport and food events, open to all

northlandindianassociation.com

Multi Ethnic Collective Whangārei (MECW)

Volunteer collective of ethnic communities that meets monthly to share experiences and collaborate

Whangarei Korean Association

Korean community association, listed in the Ministry for Ethnic Communities directory

ethniccommunities.govt.nz/community-directory/show/whangarei-korean-association

English Language Partners Northland

English classes (free for residents), home tutors, workplace English; classes in Whangārei and Kerikeri

09 438 2512

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/whangarei

Citizens Advice Bureau Whangārei

Free advice, migrant information seminars and a legal clinic

09 438 8046 cab.org.nz/location/cab-whangarei

Whangārei District Council: migrant support

Council's newcomer page and free Guide for Newcomers booklet

wdc.govt.nz/Community/Community-services/Migrant-support

Ministry for Ethnic Communities directory

Search for other ethnic associations in the Northland region

ethniccommunities.govt.nz/community-directory

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

Multicultural Whangārei (Facebook)

Event notices, English classes and community news

facebook.com/multiculturalwhangarei

Northland Indian Association Inc (Facebook)

Indian community events in Whangārei

facebook.com/Northland-Indian-Association-Inc-423467331037323

Whangaree Malayalam Association WhatsApp group

Members' WhatsApp group, used for housing tips and community support; ask to join through the WMA website

WINGS Whangārei (Facebook & Instagram @wingswhangarei)

Weekly activities for newcomer women and mums

Whangaree Business Women's Network

Monthly meet-ups for women in business, useful for partners looking for work

facebook.com/WhgBizWomensNetwork

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Francis Xavier Catholic Parish, Whangārei

Main Catholic parish; corner of Kamo Rd and Park Ave, Kensington; check the website for mass times

09 437 7902 whangareicatholic.org.nz

Holy Family Catholic Church, Kerikeri (Mid-North Catholic)

Catholic church for Kerikeri, part of the Mid-North pastoral area (Kerikeri, Paihia, Kawakawa)

09 401 9281 midnorthcatholic.org.nz

Mar Thoma and Jacobite Syrian Orthodox congregations

Kerala Christian congregations meet in Whangārei; ask the Whangaree Malayalam Association for times

wmaofficial.org/information

Whangārei Masjid (Northland Islamic Centre)

11C Porowini Ave, Morningside; Friday prayer 1:30pm year-round; women's facilities; Quran classes

whangareimasjid.co.nz

Whangaree Gurudwara Sahib

Sikh gurdwara at 23 Water St, central Whangārei

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Rasheeds Shop'n Save

Indian groceries: spices, lentils, rice and frozen foods; 3 Maunu Rd, Whangārei

09 438 4683

King's Mart Asian Grocery

Korean and Asian groceries; 18 John St, Whangārei

09 459 7649

New North Asian Supermarket

Asian supermarket in Whangārei, open daily

facebook.com/p/New-North-Asian-Supermarket-61554473970645

Northland Continental Grocers

Continental and international grocer in Whangārei

facebook.com/p/Northland-Continental-Grocers-61554598616520

MandiBazaar

Online Indian grocery delivered nationwide, handy in Kerikeri and the Bay of Islands

mandibazaar.co.nz

Halal meat and kosher food

No halal butcher or kosher supplier was confirmed locally. Ask at the Whangārei Masjid, or order from Auckland suppliers and stock up on city trips

Paihia Farmers' Market

Thursdays 10am–1:30pm, October to April, the Village Green, Paihia

bayofislandsfarmersmarket.co.nz

Whangārei markets list

All the district's markets in one place, including Town Basin artisan and night markets

whangareinz.com/Discover/Discover-Whangarei/Markets

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Pak'nSave

Cheapest big chain; the main store is in Whangārei and worth the trip for a big shop

paknsave.co.nz

Woolworths

In Whangārei, Kerikeri and the larger towns; best online ordering

woolworths.co.nz

New World

In Whangārei and Kerikeri; dearer, but good for fresh and specialty foods

newworld.co.nz

Four Square

Small-town supermarket; often the only one in rural Northland

foursquare.co.nz

Whangārei Growers Market

Every Saturday 6am–10am, Water Street car park, Whangārei

Tikipunga Market

Sundays 7am–11am, Tikipunga High School car park

Parua Bay Farmers & Crafters Market

Sundays 9am–1pm, Parua Bay Community Centre, Whangārei Heads Rd

Kerikeri Farmers' Market

Every Sunday 8:30am–12pm, Post Office car park, 10 Hobson Ave, Kerikeri

bayofislandsfarmersmarket.co.nz

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Find a school (Education Counts)

Every school in Northland, with enrolment zones
educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Schools in Whangārei

Overview of the district's 56 schools, including Māori-medium and special schools

whangareinz.com/Live-Work-Study/Study-in-Whangarei/School

Early childhood in Whangārei

Kindergartens, daycares and other early learning options

whangareinz.com/Live-Work-Study/Study-in-Whangarei/Early-childhood

School uniforms

Most schools sell uniforms (new and second-hand) through their own uniform shop or PTA; ask the school office when you enrol

Plunket Whangārei

Free support for under-fives and parents, plus car seat hire

09 438 2724 plunket.org.nz

Whangārei Parents Centre

Antenatal classes and parent coffee groups
parentcentres.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led play sessions for under-sixes; use the map to find Northland centres

playcentre.org.nz/find-your-centre

Whangārei District Libraries

Central, Kamo, Onerahi and Tikipunga branches plus a mobile library; free membership; kids' and migrant programmes

09 430 4206 wdc.govt.nz/library/Home

Whangārei Aquatic Centre

Swimming lessons for children; Ewing Rd

09 430 4072

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property: Northland rentals

Main rental listings site; good rentals go quickly

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/northland

realestate.co.nz

Homes for sale and rent across Northland

realestate.co.nz

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check what's fair for a suburb before you apply

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Trade Me flatmates wanted

Rooms in shared houses, useful for your first weeks

trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted

Find your home in Whangārei

Council-backed overview of Whangārei suburbs and housing

whangareinz.com/Create-Your-Best-Life/Find-your-home

Whangārei District Council

Rates, property information and services for Whangārei addresses

09 430 4200 wdc.govt.nz

Far North District Council

Rates and property information for Kerikeri and the Bay of Islands

fndc.govt.nz

GETTING AROUND

BusLink (Northland Regional Council)

Runs CityLink buses in Whangārei, plus Mid North, Far North, Hokianga, Hikurangi and Bream Bay Links; live bus tracker

0800 002 004 buslink.co.nz

Bee Card

Tap-on fare card used on BusLink services

beecard.co.nz

InterCity

Coaches from Whangārei and Kerikeri to Auckland and around the North Island

intercity.co.nz

Air New Zealand

Flights from Whangārei and Kerikeri (Bay of Islands) airports to Auckland

airnewzealand.co.nz

AA Centre Whangārei

Driver licensing and licence conversion; 17 James St

aa.co.nz

NZ Transport Agency: driver licences

Rules for converting an overseas licence

nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo: New Zealand

Crowd-sourced cost of living, to compare with the city you're leaving

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/country_result.jsp?country=New+Zealand

Tenancy Services market rent

Actual bond-lodged rents by suburb

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Stats NZ

Official price indexes and household spending figures

stats.govt.nz

Powerswitch

Compare power plans for your Northland address

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted budget tool

Free, independent budgeting calculator

sorted.org.nz/tools/budget-planner

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

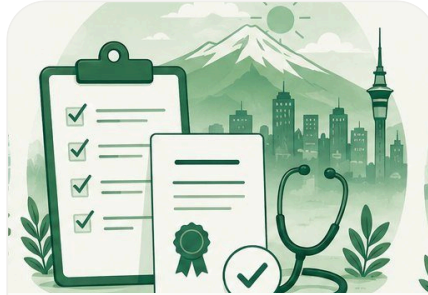
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

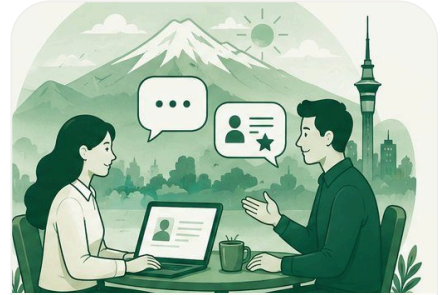
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

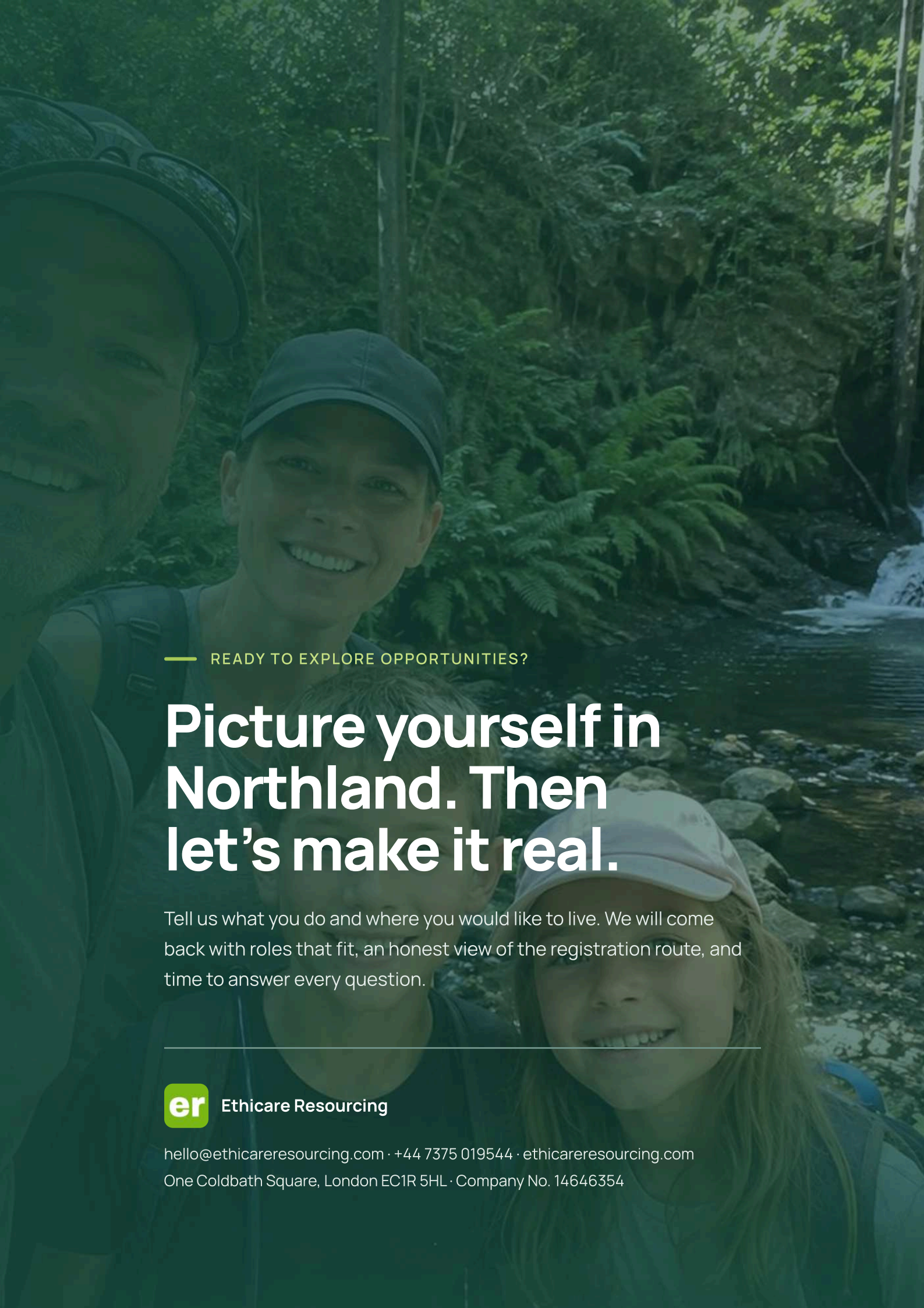
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Northland. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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